PRACTITIONER REFERENCE

# Pigment & Color Theory

Healed color = pigment + skin showing through. Plan for both.

## Fitzpatrick skin type

| I | II | III | IV | V | VI |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Very fair | Fair | Medium | Olive | Brown | Deep brown |
| Light, soft browns; skip heavy ash. | Light to medium, soft neutral. | Medium browns to match undertone. | Deeper, warmer browns. | Deep warm browns. | Deepest warm pigments. |

Types IV–VI: higher risk of dark marks and raised scars. Use machine shading, a lighter hand, patch test.

## Undertone guide

### Cool
Blue or purple veins, silver suits

Neutral or ash pigment.

### Warm
Green veins, gold suits

Neutral or warm pigment.

### Not sure
Mixed signs, or both metals suit

Neutral-warm. Brows heal cooler.

## Opposites neutralize

## Healed-color troubleshooting

| HEALS AS | LIKELY CAUSE | FIX |
|---|---|---|
| **Grey or blue** | Carbon/black-based pigment, or too deep (Tyndall effect). | Orange or warm corrector, then a warm brown. |
| **Red, pink or salmon** | Yellow in the brown faded first, leaving the red. | Green or olive corrector, or a more neutral brown. |
| **Greenish** | Yellow-based pigment over old blue-grey work. | Red or warm corrector, then a neutral-warm brown. |
| **Too dark or solid** | Over-saturated, or shade too deep for the skin. | Let it fade, or saline lighten. Lighter shade and hand next time. |

### CORRECTION RULES
- Neutralize with the opposite on the color wheel.
- Space correction sessions at least 8 weeks apart.
- Get prior brand and photos; log every lot.
- Heavy old work: lighten or saline first.

### LIP NEUTRALIZATION
- Dark or cool lips: coral or peach corrector first.
- Final lip shade at the next session, 8 weeks on.
- Plan 2–3 sessions; lips heal cooler and lighter.
- Cold sore history: client asks their physician first.

**Avoid heavy titanium dioxide lighteners.** They heal unpredictably, can leave a chalky or grey cast, and can darken under laser. Follow each pigment maker's instructions.